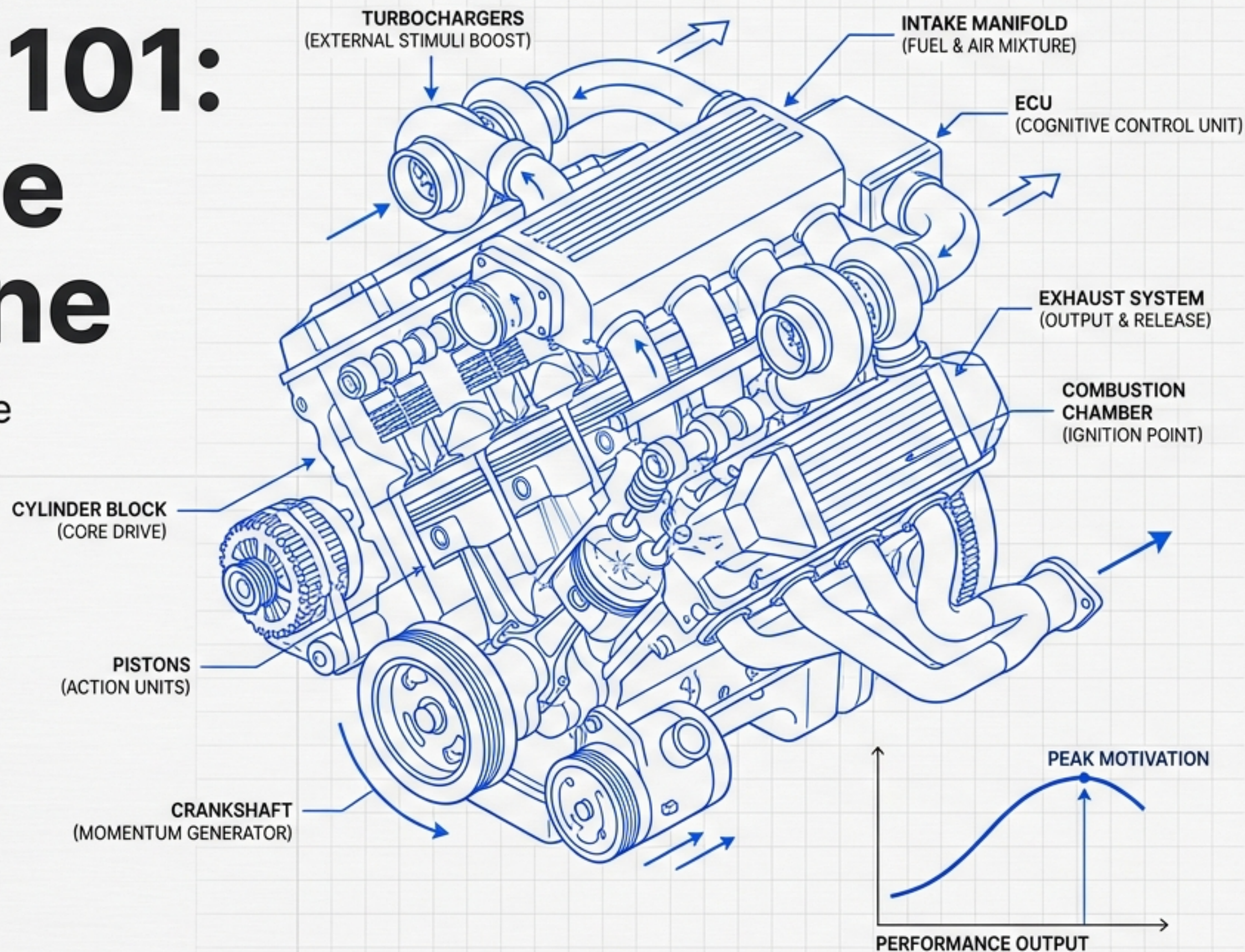


Motivation 101: The Science of the Engine

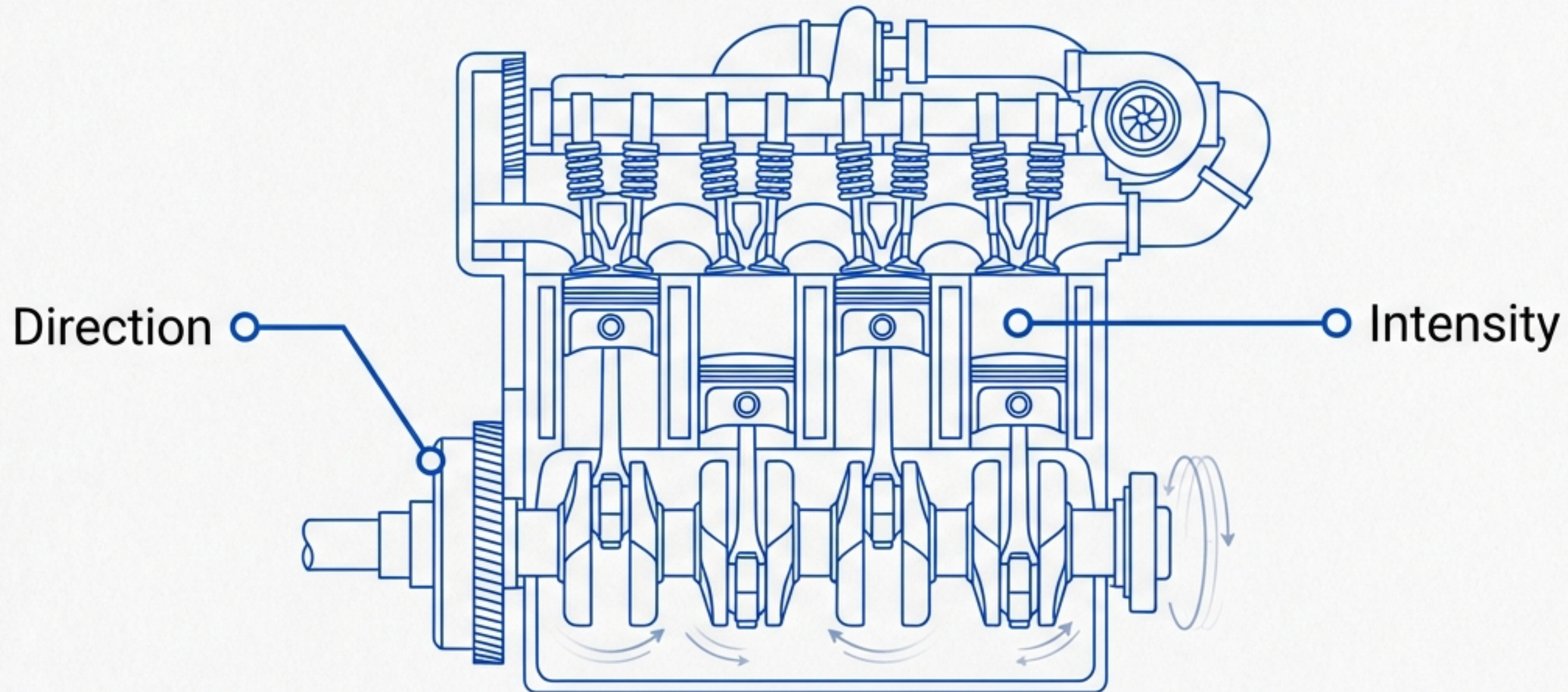
A Technical Guide to Human Drive



What is Motivation? It's Your Engine.

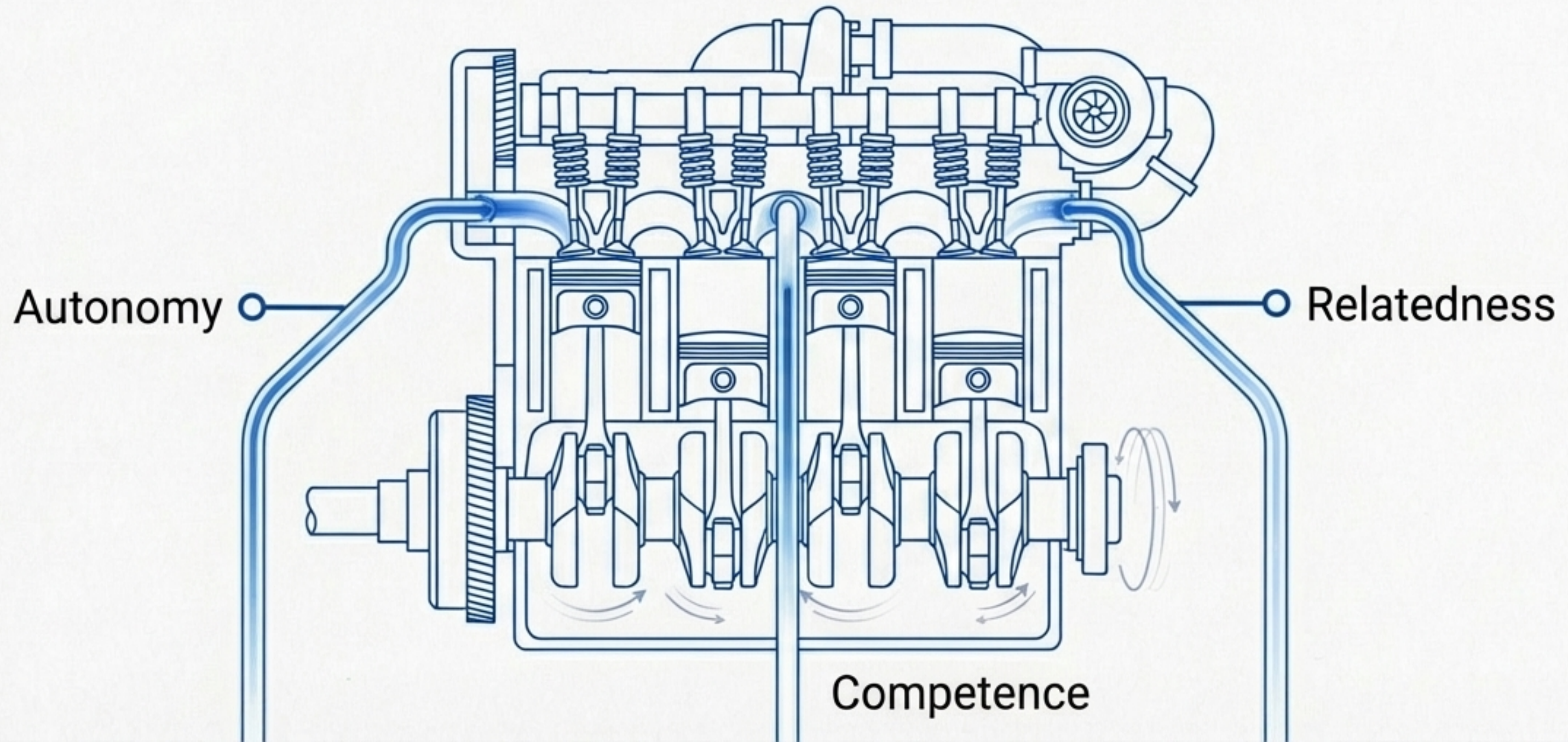
We define motivation with two key questions:

1. **Direction**: Where do you point your effort?
2. **Intensity**: How much effort do you apply?



Every Engine Needs Fuel.

High-grade performance requires three types of psychological fuel. These are innate psychological nutrients essential for growth, integrity, and well-being.



Know Your Fuel Mix.



AUTONOMY

The Driver's Seat.

The need for volition; to feel that your actions are your own choice and align with your integrated sense of self.



COMPETENCE

The Horsepower.

The need to feel effective; to master your craft and have an impact on your environment.



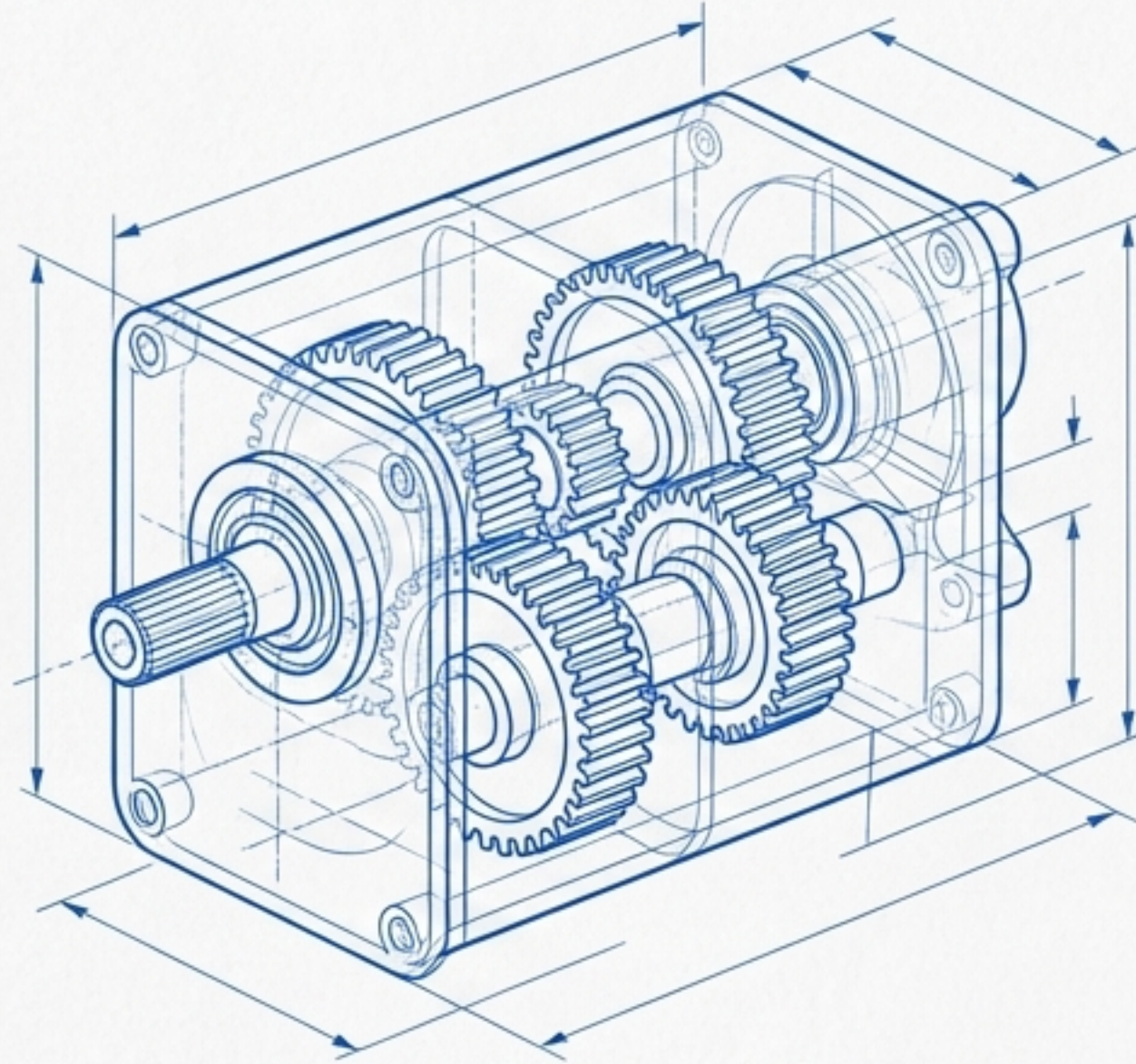
RELATEDNESS

The Pit Crew.

The need to feel connected; to care for others and be cared for by them. To be part of the mission.

The Gearbox: Shifting Your Reason for Action

The quality of your motivation isn't just about the fuel; it's about the gear you're in. Your "reason" for acting determines how efficiently you use that fuel. We're going to break down the first two gears, where most athletes get stuck.



Ever wonder why some days you feel powerful and other days you're just grinding?

1st Gear: External Regulation ('Doing it for them')

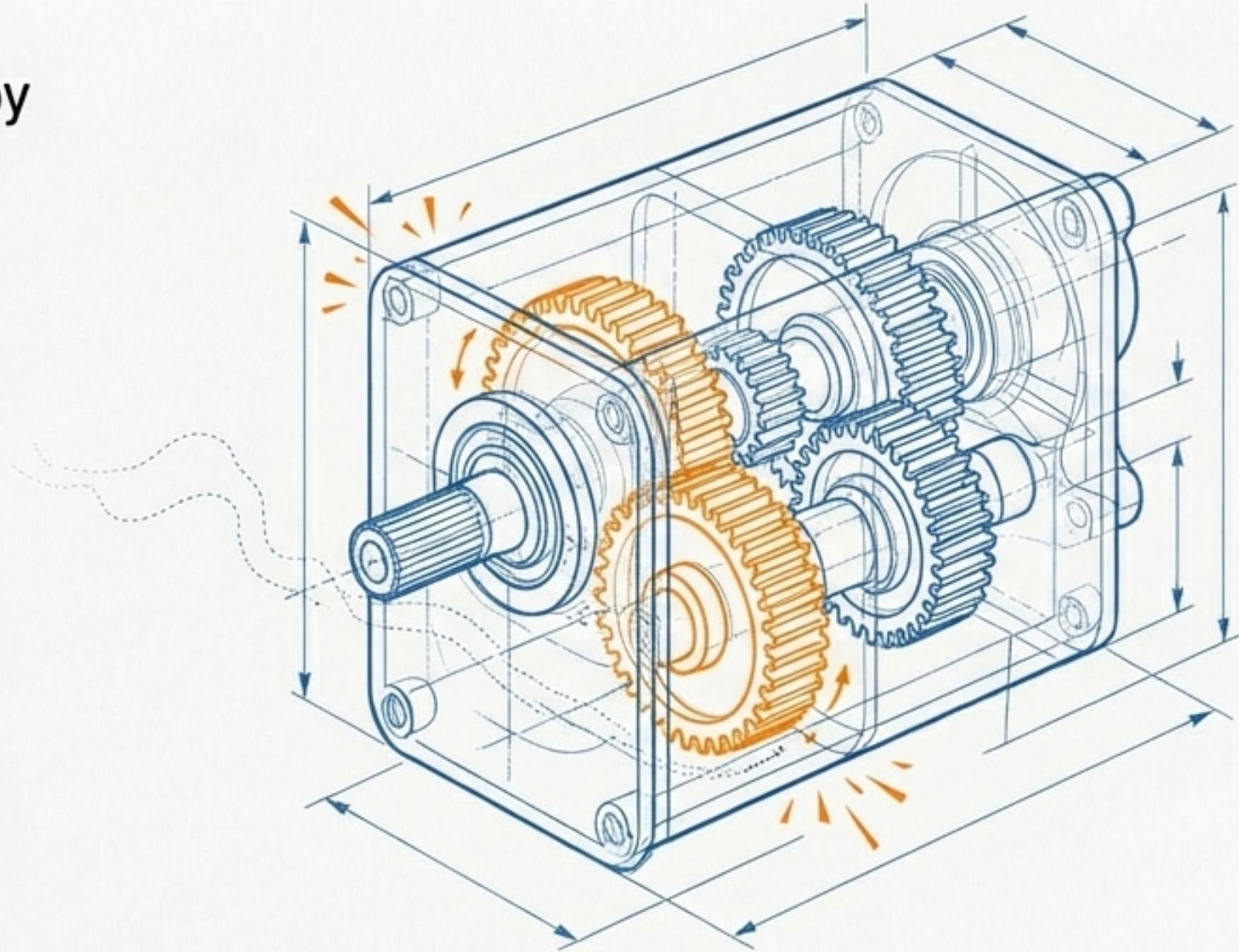
Key idea: Your behavior is controlled by external rewards or punishments.

Examples:

- I train to win the trophy.
- I practice hard so the coach won't yell at me.

The Cost

This gear burns fuel **inefficiently**. It's a **direct line to burnout**, which is characterized by a loss of motivation. According to research on overtraining, athletes in this state are at high risk. (Carter et al., 2014)



2nd Gear: Introjected Regulation ('The Internal Critic')

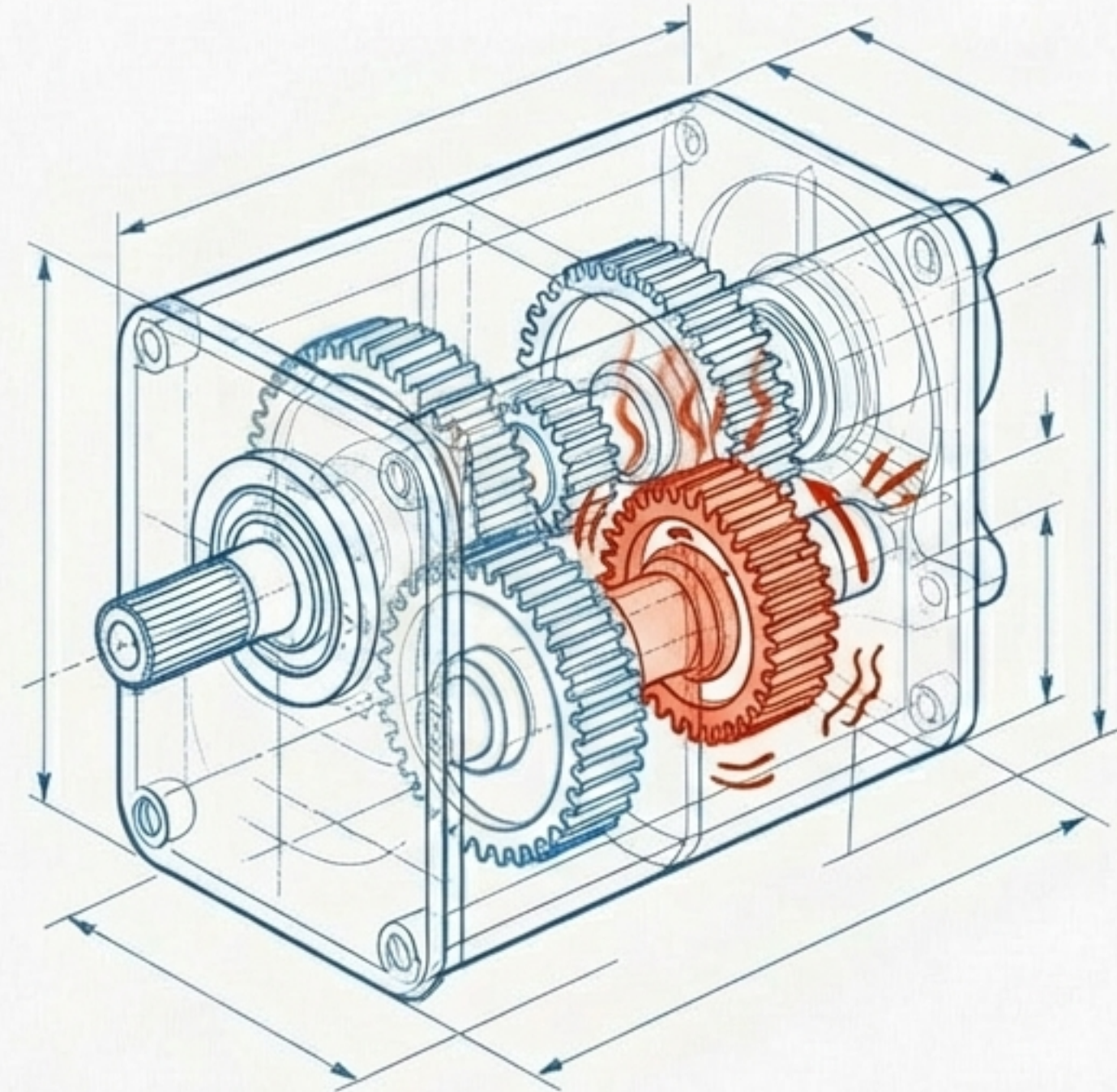
Key Idea: You take in an external rule and enforce it on yourself to avoid guilt or shame.

Internal Dialogue:

- I **should** do this extra work, or I'll feel like a failure.
- I'm doing this so I don't feel ashamed of my performance.

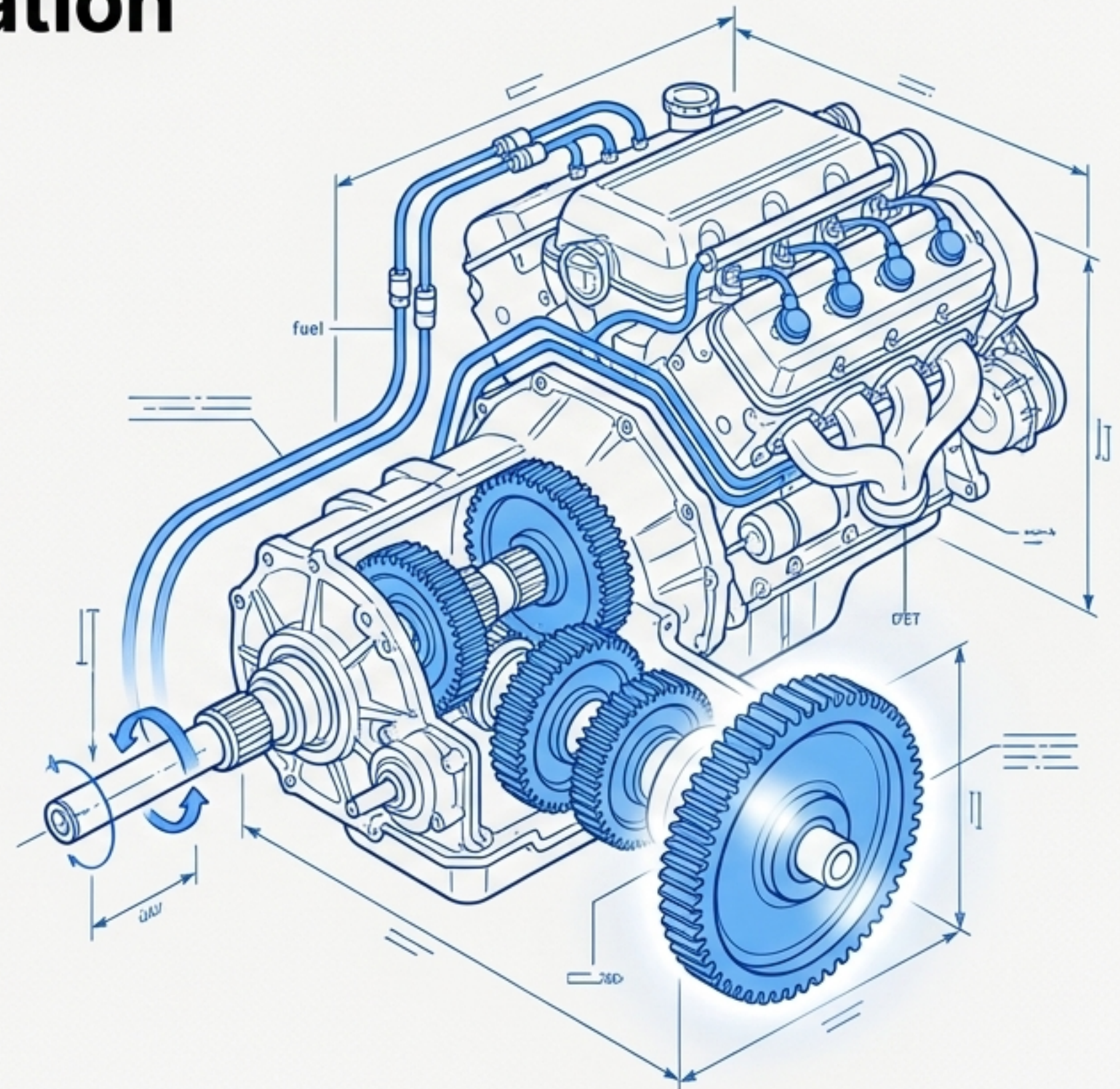
The Cost

This gear runs on high pressure. You are your own taskmaster. It feels like discipline, but it's brittle. According to Deci & Ryan, it's driven by "threats of guilt and shame." This is the Accountability Mirror used as a whip, not a tool.

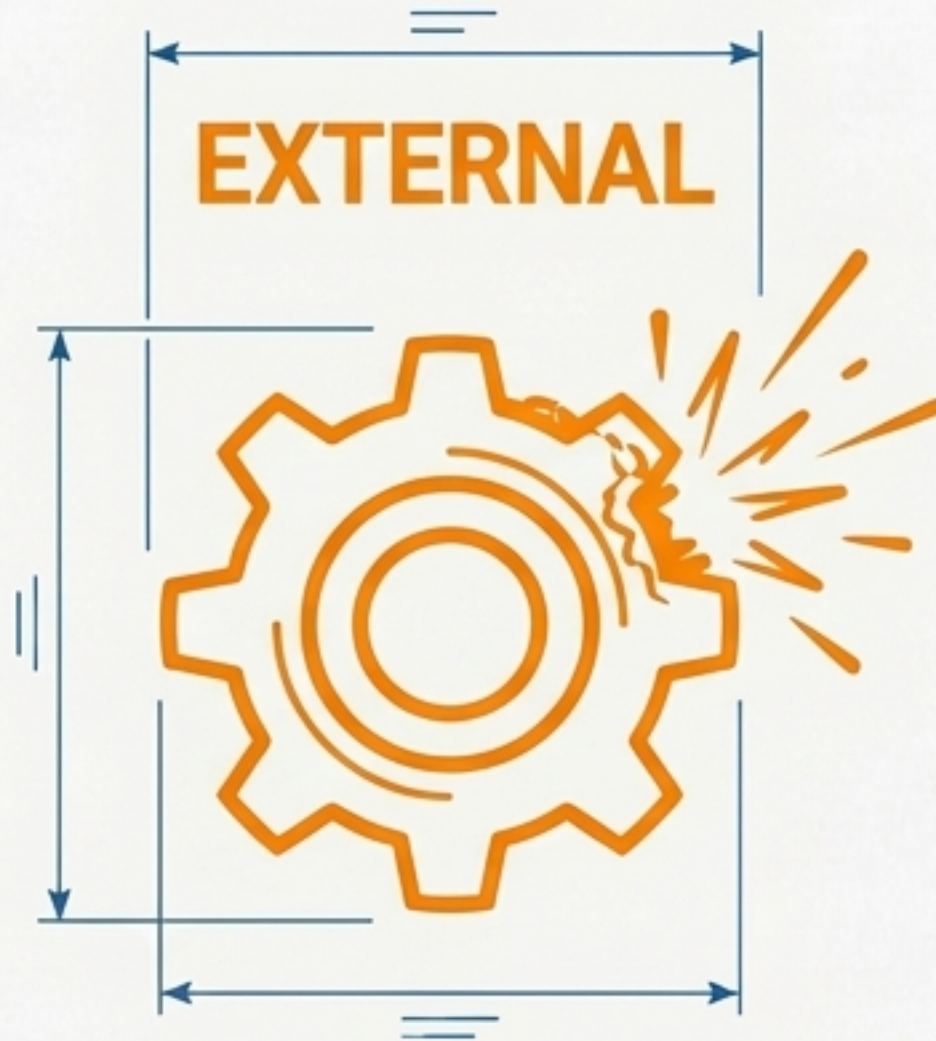


Top Gear: Integrated Regulation ("The Warrior Identity")

- **Key Idea:** The behavior is no longer just something you **do**; it's an expression of who you **are**.
- **The Transformation:** The regulation has been fully transformed into self-regulation. The value behind the action is in harmony with your core identity.
- **Internal Dialogue:**
 - "I train this way because I am a disciplined athlete."
 - "Getting up early isn't a choice; it's a **requirement** of the identity I've chosen."
- **The Result:** This is where discipline becomes automatic. The engine runs smoothly, powerfully, and is highly sustainable.



From Grinding Gears to a High-Performance Engine.



Driver: Rewards / Punishment
Feels Like: A Grind
Result: Burnout

INTROJECTED



Driver: Guilt / Shame
Feels Like: Pressure
Result: Brittle



Driver: Identity / Values
Feels Like: Automatic
Result: Enduring

Phase 1 Complete: You Understand the Engine.

Now that we understand the levels of the engine, our next session—Phase 2—will show you how to redline it.

PHASE 2:
WARRIOR DISCIPLINE